

Drugs

Igcse Biology

What a drug is

A **drug** 药物 is any substance taken into the body that changes or affects the **chemical reactions** 化学反应 in the body. Many drugs are medicines that help to treat illness.

Antibiotics

Antibiotics 抗生素 are drugs used to treat bacterial **infections** 感染. They **kill bacteria** 细菌, or stop them growing, but they do **not** affect **viruses** 病毒. This is why antibiotics cannot cure a cold or the flu, which are caused by viruses.

Antibiotic resistance

Some bacteria are **resistant** 耐药 to an antibiotic —the antibiotic no longer kills them. These bacteria survive and multiply, so the antibiotic slowly becomes less effective for everyone.

(Supplement) To slow this down, antibiotics should be used **only when they are really needed**, and the full course should always be finished. Using antibiotics too often lets resistant bacteria, such as **MRSA**, spread.

Exam tips

- A drug is **any** substance that changes the body's chemical reactions —not only illegal drugs.
- Antibiotics kill **bacteria** only; they do **not** work on **viruses** (so they are useless against colds and flu).
- Overusing antibiotics leads to **resistant** bacteria like MRSA. Use them only when needed, and finish the whole course.